

[SCHOOL NAME — PLACEHOLDER LETTERHEAD]

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Class 4 EVS — CA-1 (Hard) — Answer Key

Class : 4

Subject : EVS (Our Wondrous World)

Max Marks : 30

Duration : 1 Hour

Syllabus: Chapters 1–3 — Living Together, Exploring Our Neighbourhood, Nature Trail

General Instructions: All questions are compulsory. For Section A, write the correct option letter.

ANSWER KEY

SECTION A — Multiple Choice Questions (1 Mark each)

1. Which best explains why sociologists and educators emphasise teaching about diverse community roles from a young age? (1 Mark)

A. To confuse children

B. To build early understanding of interdependence and respect for different kinds of work in society ✓

C. Roles are unimportant to teach

D. Only one role matters in society

2. If a neighbourhood map shows many schools but very few hospitals, what might this suggest about the area, with appropriate caution about drawing firm conclusions? (1 Mark)

A. The area definitely has no sick people

B. It might suggest an area with a younger population or a current gap in healthcare access, though further investigation would be needed to confirm ✓

C. Maps never provide any useful information

D. This detail is completely meaningless

3. Which best explains why a single nature trail visit provides only a limited snapshot of an ecosystem? (1 Mark)

A. A single visit shows everything about an ecosystem

B. Ecosystems change with seasons, time of day, and weather, so one visit only captures a small part of ongoing natural patterns ✓

C. Ecosystems never change

D. Nature trails have no connection to ecosystems

4. Which statement best reflects a balanced view of joint versus nuclear family structures? (1 Mark)

A. Joint families are always better than nuclear families

B. Nuclear families are always better than joint families

C. Each structure has its own strengths and challenges, and neither is inherently superior to the other ✓

D. Family structure has no effect on daily life at all

5. Why might increasing urbanisation (more people moving to cities) create new challenges for maintaining social harmony described in "Living Together"? (1 Mark)

A. Urbanisation has no effect on communities

B. Rapid growth and diverse populations can create more opportunities for misunderstanding, requiring more conscious effort to maintain harmony ✓

C. Cities never have any social challenges

D. Social harmony is only relevant in villages

6. Which best explains why "Exploring Our Neighbourhood" likely encourages hands-on observation rather than only using pre-made maps or descriptions? (1 Mark)

A. Pre-made maps are always more accurate

B. Hands-on observation builds active learning skills and a personal, deeper connection to one's own surroundings ✓

C. Observation skills are unnecessary for young students

D. There is no benefit to direct observation

7. If two communities have very different roles filled by their members (for example, one has many farmers, another has many factory workers), what does this most likely reflect? (1 Mark)

A. One community is better than the other

B. Differences in the natural resources, location, or economic activities available in each area ✓

C. This has no connection to a community's environment

D. All communities must have identical roles

SECTION B — Short Answer Questions (2 Marks each)

1. Critically analyse why defining a "typical" family structure might be misleading, using reasoning connected to the diversity described in "Living Together". (0 Marks)

► Since families can take many valid forms - nuclear, joint, single-parent, or extended - labelling one type as "typical" risks making children from other family structures feel their family is somehow abnormal or lesser, when in reality, what matters most for a healthy family is the care and support within it, not a specific structural format.

2. Explain how the skills learnt in "Exploring Our Neighbourhood" (observation, mapping) might be foundational for understanding more complex subjects like geography in later years. (0 Marks)

► Learning to observe surroundings carefully and represent them through simple maps builds foundational spatial reasoning and observational skills that directly support later, more advanced geography topics, such as understanding larger-scale maps, urban planning, or regional geography, showing how early observational skills scaffold future learning.

3. Discuss why a nature trail experience might have a different educational impact on a child living in a city compared to a child living in a rural area. (0 Marks)

► A city child, who may have less regular exposure to natural environments, might find a nature trail a novel and eye-opening experience, deepening their connection to nature; a rural child, who may already be more familiar with natural surroundings, might instead benefit more from developing a more detailed, scientific understanding of what they already casually observe daily, showing that the same activity can have different but equally valuable educational impacts depending on a child's background.

4. Critically evaluate whether "Living Together" sufficiently prepares children to handle real disagreements within a community, or if it primarily focuses on an idealised, harmonious view. (0 Marks)

► While the chapter likely emphasises the positive, harmonious aspects of community roles and cooperation, this idealised focus may not fully prepare children for real disagreements or conflicts, which require additional skills like negotiation, compromise, and conflict resolution - skills that may need to be reinforced through further lessons or real-life guided experiences beyond just this chapter's content.

5. Analyse how the physical layout of a neighbourhood (as explored in "Exploring Our Neighbourhood") might influence the social interactions described in "Living Together". (0 Marks)

► A neighbourhood with shared spaces like parks or community centres likely encourages more social interaction and stronger community bonds, while a neighbourhood with widely spaced, isolated homes and little shared public space might lead to less frequent interaction between community members, showing that physical design can directly influence social outcomes.

6. Discuss the potential tension between human development (building roads, houses) and preserving natural environments (as valued in "Nature Trail"), and explain how this tension might be balanced. (0 Marks)

► Human development is necessary for meeting practical needs like housing and transportation, but excessive or careless development can damage natural environments and reduce biodiversity; a balanced approach might involve careful urban planning that preserves green spaces and natural habitats alongside necessary human infrastructure, showing that development and conservation do not have to be entirely opposing forces.

SECTION C — Short Answer Questions (Explain) (3 Marks each)

1. Critically analyse how "Living Together", "Exploring Our Neighbourhood", and "Nature Trail" together represent three interconnected layers of a child's environment - social, built, and natural - and discuss why understanding all three is necessary for a complete environmental education. (0 Marks)

► "Living Together" represents the social layer, focusing on relationships, roles, and cooperation among people within families and communities.
► "Exploring Our Neighbourhood" represents the built layer, focusing on human-made structures like buildings, roads, and transportation that communities create to meet their needs.
► "Nature Trail" represents the natural layer, focusing on the ecosystems, plants, and animals that exist independently of, but are often affected by, human activity.
► Understanding all three layers together is necessary for a complete environmental education because they are deeply interconnected in real life - human social organisation shapes the built environment, which in turn interacts with and impacts the natural environment, meaning that a child who only understands one layer would have an incomplete picture of how their world truly functions.

2. Evaluate whether the skills of observation, taught similarly in both "Exploring Our Neighbourhood" and "Nature Trail", represent the same type of skill applied to different contexts, or fundamentally different skills. (0 Marks)

► On the surface, both chapters teach observation - carefully noticing and recording details about surroundings, whether human-made or natural.
► However, observing a neighbourhood may require more attention to function and purpose (why is this building here, what is this road used for), while observing nature may require more attention to relationships and behaviour (how do these living things interact).
► Despite these contextual differences, at their core both are the same fundamental skill - careful, attentive observation - applied to different types of environments, suggesting that this is a genuinely transferable skill rather than two unrelated abilities.

SECTION D — Long Answer Questions (5 Marks each)

1. Write a comprehensive essay analysing how "Living Together", "Exploring Our Neighbourhood", and "Nature Trail" together build a foundational understanding of interconnected systems - social, built, and natural - and discuss the broader life skills and values this understanding cultivates in young learners. (0 Marks)

► "Living Together" introduces children to the social systems that structure human life, teaching them to recognise and value the diverse roles and relationships that allow communities to function and support one another.
► "Exploring Our Neighbourhood" builds on this by developing observational and analytical skills applied to the built environment, helping children understand how physical spaces are organised to serve human needs.
► "Nature Trail" extends this observational skill further into the natural world, fostering appreciation and understanding of ecological relationships and the interdependence of living and non-living things.
► Together, these three chapters cultivate broader life skills - critical observation, systems thinking, empathy, and environmental responsibility - that extend far beyond the specific content of Class 4 EVS, laying a foundation for young learners to become thoughtful, engaged citizens who understand and value the interconnected social, built, and natural systems that shape their world.